

Microsoft launches Azure location based services

Addressing a gathering at Automobility LA 2017 in Los Angeles, California, Sam George, director – Azure IoT, Microsoft said, “Microsoft is making an effort to solve mobility challenges and bring government bodies, private companies and automotive OEMs together, using Microsoft’s intelligent cloud platform.”

The new location capabilities will provide cloud developers critical geographical data to power smart cities and Internet of Things (IoT) solutions across industries. This includes manufacturing, automotive, logistics, urban planning and retail, etc.



TomTom Telematics will be the first official partner for the service, supplying critical location and real-time traffic data, providing Microsoft customers with advanced location and mapping capabilities.

Microsoft’s Azure location based services will offer enterprise customers location capabilities integrated in the cloud to help any industry improve traffic flow. Microsoft also announced that Azure LBS will be launched in 2018, and will be available globally in more than 30 languages.

It has become increasingly evident that the future of AI needs more than just ethical direction and government oversight. It would be comforting to know that the tech giants are on the same page too. The machines, and the humans who will rely on them, need the biggest companies building AI to take on a fair share of responsibility for the future.

Four tech giants using Linux change their open source licensing policies

The GNU Public License version 2 (GPLv2) is arguably the most important open source licence for one reason—Linux uses it. On November 27, 2017, three tech power houses that use Linux—Facebook, Google and IBM, as well as the major Linux distributor Red Hat, announced they would extend additional rights to help companies who’ve made GPLv2 open source licence compliance errors and mistakes.

The GPLv2 and its close relative, GNU Lesser General Public License (LGPL), are widely used open source software licences. When the GPL version 3 (GPLv3) was released, it came with an express termination approach. This termination policy in GPLv3 provided a way for companies to correct licensing errors and mistakes. This approach allows licence compliance enforcement that is consistent with community norms.

FreeNAS 11.1 provides greater performance and cloud integration

FreeNAS 11.1 adds cloud integration and OpenZFS performance improvements, including the ability to prioritise ‘resilvering’ operations, and preliminary Docker support to the world’s most popular software-defined storage operating system.

It also adds a cloud sync (data import/export to the cloud) feature, which lets you sync (similar to back up), move (erase from source) or copy (only changed data) data to and from public cloud providers that include Amazon S3 (Simple Storage Services), Backblaze B2 Cloud, Google Cloud and Microsoft Azure.

OpenZFS has noticeable performance improvements for handling multiple snapshots and large files. Resilver Priority has been added to the ‘Storage’ screen of the graphical user interface, allowing you to configure ‘resilvering’ at a higher priority at specific times. This helps to mitigate the inherited challenges and risks associated with storage array rebuilds on very large capacity drives.

The latest release includes an updated preview of the beta version of the new administrator graphical user interface, including the ability to select display themes. It can be downloaded from freenas.org/download.



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